CRIS LOPEZ

THE AI REMOTE WORK PLAYBOOK

How to Find Opportunities, Pass AI Assessments, and Get Paid to Help Build the Future of AI

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Contents

Preface		v
	About the Author: Cris Lopez, PhD	v
1	Chapter 1	1
	THE QUICK-START BLUEPRINT: YOUR 30-DAY ACTION PLAN	1
2	Chapter 2	4
	THE OPPORTUNITY IS NOW	4
3	Chapter 3	8
	FIND THE RIGHT OPPORTUNITIES	8
4	Chapter 4	11
	BECOME A COMPETITIVE APPLICANT	11
5	Chapter 5	13
	PASS ZARA AND THE AI INTERVIEW	13
6	Chapter 6	16
	MASTER THE ASSESSMENTS	16
7	Chapter 7	18
	GET ACCEPTED, GET PAID, AND KEEP GOING	18
8	Chapter 8	20
	THE BONUS RESOURCE VAULT	20
9	Chapter 9	23
	THE SIMULATION LAB: PRACTICE EXERCISES	23
10	Chapter 10	26
	FINAL CHECKLIST & GLOSSARY	26
11	Chapter 11	28

BONUS CHAPTER: THE EXPERIENCED PROFESSIONAL'S ADVANTAGE 28
12 Chapter 12 30
BONUS CHAPTER: THE TECHNICAL EVALUATOR'S TECH STACK 30
13 Chapter 13 32
THE SIMULATION LAB (EXPANDED) 32
14 Chapter 14 35
YOUR NEXT ACTION STARTS TODAY 35

Preface

About the Author: Cris Lopez, PhD

I did not write this book based on theory. I wrote it based on over 500 hours of paid, hands-on work evaluating and training AI models. Combining decades of academic rigor and executive leadership experience, I built a systematic approach to navigating the new AI workforce. This system has resulted in successfully landing roles, passing rigorous assessments, and receiving weekly inquiries and "instant offers" from platforms like Mercor, micro1, Ethos, and Alignerr. I have navigated the onboarding processes for dozens of other platforms, learning exactly what separates a rejected application from a hired contractor. This playbook is the exact field guide I wish I had when I started.

1

Chapter 1

THE QUICK-START BLUEPRINT: YOUR 30-DAY ACTION PLAN

Do not read this book and wait for the perfect moment. The opportunity is moving quickly. Use this blueprint to launch your pipeline today.

Days 1–3: Automate Your Pipeline

- **Step 1: Set up your command center.** Go to **airemoteworkdashboard.com** and create your free account. This platform is your immediate competitive advantage, centralizing all currently available jobs on platforms like Mercor and micro1 in one easily searchable location.
- **Step 2: Build your master profile.** Write a one-page inventory of your skills, subject expertise, languages, and evidence. Upload this baseline resume into the dashboard.
- **Step 3: Leverage the Resume Adapter.** Do not waste hours manually rewriting your resume for every application. The

dashboard features a proprietary "Resume Adapter"—you submit your baseline resume once, and the system instantly tailors and adapts it to match the specific requirements, keywords, and formatting needed for every individual job you select.

Days 4–7: Apply and Practice

- Select two or three roles from the dashboard that offer a strong fit and where you have confirmed your geographic eligibility.
- Generate your targeted applications using the Resume Adapter, ensuring your evidence aligns perfectly with the job descriptions.
- Submit the applications and log your submission dates to track your next actions.

Week Two: Expand Your Funnel

- Add well-matched opportunities by reviewing the newly populated specialist and generalist roles on your dashboard.
- Transition from applying to practicing. Run through the core skills (rubric adherence, hallucination identification) using the Simulation Lab located in Part V of this book.

Weeks Three and Four: Evaluate and Adapt

- Review your conversion rates. If your applications are

not resulting in assessment invitations, refine the master resume you uploaded to the dashboard. If you are passing assessments but not receiving offers, drill the Zara Interview Prep framework located in the Bonus Vault.

Pro-Tip: The Daily 30-Minute Routine Spend 5 minutes checking airemoteworkdashboard.com for new listings, 10 minutes using the Resume Adapter to fire off one highly targeted application, 10 minutes completing a practice exercise from this playbook, and 5 minutes recording your results. Consistency beats intensity.

2

Chapter 2

THE OPPORTUNITY IS NOW

1. The New AI Workforce

AI work is not one occupation. It is a family of tasks that help systems become more useful, accurate, safe, and aligned with what people need. A model may generate an answer in seconds, but someone still has to determine whether the answer is correct, relevant, complete, appropriately cautious, and supported by evidence. Human judgment supplies the reference point against which model behavior is measured.

Common work categories include response evaluation, preference ranking, fact-checking, data annotation, prompt and example writing, coding review, domain-specific problem solving, multilingual evaluation, audio or image labeling, and red-team testing. A single platform may offer several categories, while a particular contract may involve only one narrow workflow.

2. What is an AI Remote Worker?

For this book, an AI remote worker is someone who performs paid work that supports the development, testing, evaluation, or operation of AI systems, usually online. This broad label includes employees, freelancers, independent contractors, and project-based contributors. The legal relationship matters: contractors may not receive employee benefits, paid leave, or guaranteed hours.

Do not assume 'remote' means 'available worldwide'. A listing may restrict applicants by country, language, work authorization, or payment region. Read eligibility before investing hours in an application.

3. Why Your Past Non-AI Experience is Your Unfair Advantage

Beginners sometimes assume they must learn machine learning or become prompt engineers before applying. That is often unnecessary for roles centered on evaluation, writing, language, search, data collection, or domain knowledge.

Your professional history may be more relevant than you think.

- **Teachers** excel at evaluating written work against explicit criteria, giving specific feedback, and identifying recurring misconceptions.
- **Customer Service Representatives** are experts at resolving ambiguous cases while maintaining strict policy accuracy and clear documentation.
- **Bilingual Professionals** notice translation errors and cul-

tural mismatches.

Do not overstate qualifications. If you have used AI tools but have not trained models professionally, say that. Trust is an asset. A truthful, specific application is stronger than an inflated one that collapses under questioning.

4. Why Starting Now Matters

The case for starting now is not that every opportunity will disappear tomorrow. It is that the skills required to compete are learned through practice. You can learn to interpret rubrics, write concise rationales, verify claims, explain decisions aloud, and organize an application pipeline before you are under pressure.

Early action also gives you information. You discover which platforms accept applicants from your location, which skill categories fit you, how long applications take, what assessments demand, and how much administration is involved.

5. Can This Change Your Financial Life?

It can become meaningful income for some people. It can also remain occasional, inconsistent, or unavailable. The honest answer depends on the work you qualify for, hours offered, actual rate, taxes and expenses, and whether projects continue.

Use a conservative model. If a project pays an advertised rate but you spend unpaid time qualifying, reading instructions,

waiting for tasks, correcting work, or handling administration, your effective hourly rate may be lower. Calculate three numbers: the rate for approved work, the realistic hours you can obtain, and the unpaid time required.

3

Chapter 3

FIND THE RIGHT OPPORTUNITIES

6. The AI Work Opportunity Map

Search by task and skill, not only by 'AI job'. Useful terms include *AI trainer, AI evaluator, model evaluator, data annotator, human feedback, response ranking, search quality rater, language specialist, transcription quality, coding evaluator, expert reviewer, red-team tester,* and *AI data specialist.*

Separate opportunities into three groups:

Generalist roles emphasizing language, reasoning, and instruction-following.

Specialist roles requiring expertise such as law, medicine, accounting, finance, engineering, education, or software development.

Data-production roles involving labeling, transcription, collection, or validation.

7. Platforms Worth Investigating

The following are examples to research, not endorsements or guarantees of current work.

- **Mercor:** Connects professionals with AI-related projects and expert work. Opportunities can be domain-specific and may involve a profile, assessment, or AI interview.
- **micro1:** Recruits for AI roles and uses an AI recruiter named Zara for structured candidate interviews.
- **Ethos & Alignerr:** High-volume platforms frequently matching domain experts and evaluators to ongoing projects.
- **DataAnnotation:** Describes projects involving chatbot interaction, writing and editing, coding, and specialist tasks.
- **Outlier:** Offers AI-training work for contributors with different backgrounds, including specialist and generalist roles.
- **TELUS Digital AI & RWS TrainAI:** Communities offering roles across areas including language, search relevance, online rating, and data collection.

8. Global Opportunities and Geographic Restrictions

Location affects more than time zones. Platforms may be limited by client contracts, data protection, language demand, payment infrastructure, tax arrangements, or local labor rules. Read the exact wording: 'remote—United States' is not the same as 'remote—worldwide'. Check whether the role requires residence, citizenship, work authorization, a local phone number, a payment account, or a language variant. Do not use a VPN or

false address to bypass eligibility; misrepresentation can lead to account closure or withheld work.

Scam Alert: Spotting Fake Opportunities A legitimate platform may ask for identity verification after you apply, but verify the official domain first.

- Never pay an application fee, deposit, training fee, or fee to unlock tasks.
- Be suspicious of guaranteed income, implausibly high pay for trivial work, or pressure to act immediately.
- Never accept a check and send part of the money elsewhere, buy gift cards, or move funds for a recruiter.
- Do not install remote-access software or unknown executables at a stranger's request.

9. Build Your Personal Opportunity Pipeline

A pipeline ensures that one unanswered application does not stop your search. Using airemoteworkdashboard.com, you can easily track company, role, official URL, country eligibility, date found, date applied, required skills, assessment status, next action, and outcome.

Set a sustainable weekly target. For example, research five roles, submit two or three well-matched applications, and complete two practice exercises. Ten carefully matched applications can teach you more than fifty generic submissions. Review the pipeline weekly: Which roles fit? Which applications took too long? Which assessments exposed a weakness? Use evidence to change your strategy.

4

Chapter 4

BECOME A COMPETITIVE APPLICANT

10. Translate Your Experience

Your resume must prove your ability to exercise judgment, follow rules, and communicate clearly. Translate duties into evidence of precision and results rather than inventing experience with AI models. Use the evidence formula: **Action + Context + Standard + Result**.

- *Weak:* "Detail-oriented team player".
- *Strong:* "Reviewed 80 submissions per week against a six-part rubric, documenting recurring errors with 99% accuracy".

11. Tailoring and Pipeline Management

Tailoring is not keyword stuffing; it is selecting the most relevant truthful evidence for a particular role. Map each requirement to a real example from your background. Apply strategically when you meet essential requirements or can make a credible case for transferable skills, rather than spending hours on roles that exclude your location.

Pro-Tip: Never Tailor Manually Again

Instead of spending an hour rewriting your resume for every single application, use the **Resume Adapter at airemoteworkdashboard.com**. Once your Master Profile is saved, the system automatically reads the job description and instantly rewrites your resume's bullet points to highlight the exact evidence the platform's applicant tracking system is looking for.

5

Chapter 5

PASS ZARA AND THE AI INTERVIEW

12. Meet Zara (micro1's AI Recruiter)

Zara is micro1's AI recruiter, conducting conversational, role-specific interviews. The format may include open-ended technical questions, scenario questions, or human-data exercises depending on the role. There is no reliable reason to assume every candidate gets the same script. Do not memorize answers designed for someone else's background. Prepare the thinking process you will use when an unfamiliar question appears. Treat Zara as a structured assessment, not a casual chat. Explain what you know, how you reach a conclusion, and how you would verify your answer.

13. Answer Clearly Under Pressure

Build six to eight examples that demonstrate problem-solving, learning quickly, handling ambiguity, and communicating clearly. Use the **STAR method** (Situation, Task, Action, Result).

A strong spoken answer has four parts: direct answer, reasoning, example or evidence, and conclusion.

- If you make a mistake, correct it directly instead of spending the rest of the answer defending it.
- If you cannot recall a fact, distinguish what you remember from what you would need to verify. Calibrated uncertainty is a massive strength when paired with a plan.

Pro-Tip: The "Thinking Out Loud" Framework

AI interviewers like Zara are evaluating your reasoning as much as your final answer. When presented with a complex scenario, say: *"Before I answer, I am making the assumption that X is true. Based on that, my first step would be..."* This proves you do not just guess; you operate systematically.

14. Technical Setup and Common Mistakes

Do not let easily preventable errors sink an AI interview.

- **The Setup:** Test your microphone, camera, browser permissions, and lighting before the session. Choose a quiet space and close unrelated applications and notifications. Read the platform's rules about permitted resources and AI tools.
- **The Mistakes to Avoid:** Answering a different question

from the one asked. Making broad claims without concrete evidence. Pretending to know a fact instead of explaining how to verify it. Contradicting your resume or claiming skills you cannot demonstrate. Treating a practice script as a guaranteed route to passing.

6

Chapter 6

MASTER THE ASSESSMENTS

15. How Assessments Work

Assessments reduce uncertainty about whether you can perform a task. They test domain knowledge, written communication, careful reading, language proficiency, coding, annotation, reasoning, or rubric adherence. Read the instructions before beginning. Identify the objective, criteria, required output format, time limit, prohibited tools, and rules for uncertainty. Small formatting requirements can matter when work is evaluated systematically. Repetitive work is difficult precisely because it demands consistent judgment. Your aim is not to sound impressive; it is to satisfy the task.

16. Evaluate AI Responses Professionally

When comparing two AI responses, separate dimensions that are easy to blur. Is the answer correct? Does it follow instructions? Is it relevant and complete enough? Is it clear? Does it create safety or privacy problems? A fluent answer can still fail the central task. Use the project's rubric. If correctness outranks style, do not let elegant prose compensate for a serious factual error.

Write a strong evaluation rationale. Identify the criterion, cite specific evidence, explain why it matters, and state the consequence for the request. Do not merely repeat the rating.

17. Identify Hallucinations and Subtle Errors

A hallucination is an unsupported or fabricated claim presented as true. It may be a fake citation, invented statistic, nonexistent feature, incorrect legal rule, or plausible but false explanation. Natural wording is not evidence of truth. Look for claims that deserve verification: dates, amounts, names, quotes, formulas, citations, medical statements, legal requirements, and current company policies.

Pro-Tip: Escalate Responsibly Consistency does not mean switching off judgment; it means using judgment within the boundaries of the task. If a rubric is genuinely ambiguous and two rules conflict, do not guess. Document the exact point of tension, explain your interpretation, and use the designated escalation path. Evaluators who flag broken instructions are highly valued.

7

Chapter 7

GET ACCEPTED, GET PAID, AND KEEP GOING

18. Your First Tasks: Quality Over Speed

Your first assignments are a chance to learn the real workflow. Read instructions, note examples, and create a personal checklist that does not violate confidentiality rules. Do not race through early work to maximize volume. First establish what a correct submission looks like and how quality is assessed. Once accuracy is consistent, improve speed by reducing unnecessary effort—not by skipping required checks.

19. Understand Actual Earnings

Advertised hourly rates are not always equivalent to earnings per hour spent. Some projects pay per task; some pay approved time; others have limits, unpaid qualification steps, or variable

task supply.

- **Effective Hourly Earnings** = Money received divided by *all* hours spent on that work, including unpaid preparation and administration.

Track gross earnings separately from platform fees, transfer fees, currency conversion, taxes, equipment, and internet costs.

Scam Alert: Protecting Your Payouts Make sure the payment account belongs to you and meets platform requirements. Understand transfer fees, conversion costs, minimum payout thresholds, and timing. Never let a recruiter use your account to receive or forward money, and never accept a check where you are asked to send part of the funds elsewhere.

20. Build a Sustainable Portfolio

Projects end. Demand changes. A platform can accept you but have no tasks for weeks. This is not necessarily a personal failure, but it is a reason not to depend on one source of work. When tasks stop, limit unpaid time spent waiting. Use the gap productively: apply elsewhere, practice the most relevant skill, update your resume with truthful experience, and review income records. Keep your pipeline active on your dashboard even when one platform is busy.

8

Chapter 8

THE BONUS RESOURCE VAULT

Resource 1: The AI Resume Adapter Prompt

If you are away from airemoteworkdashboard.com and need to use ChatGPT or Claude to analyze a job description, copy and paste this exact prompt:

"Act as an expert technical recruiter. Analyze the following job description against my attached resume. Extract essential requirements, preferred qualifications, and assessment steps. For each requirement, identify evidence explicitly present in my resume. Do not invent experience. Mark unsupported requirements as gaps. End with a fit assessment and rewrite my bullet points to highlight alignment with the role's specific rubric."

Resource 2: The Resume Evidence Matrix

When building your Master Profile on the dashboard, ensure you have evidence for these core AI-work requirements:

- **Requirement:** Following Complex Rubrics.
- *Your Evidence:* Where, when, and under what constraints did you evaluate work against a strict standard?
- **Requirement:** Identifying Factual Errors (Hallucinations).
- *Your Evidence:* When have you had to verify claims, trace sources, or correct confident but incorrect information?
- **Requirement:** Handling Ambiguity.
- *Your Evidence:* Describe a time you escalated a broken process or clarified conflicting instructions.

Resource 3: The Zara Interview Prep Framework

Use this cheat sheet to prepare your stories before initiating the micro1 AI recruiter session.

"Walk me through your reasoning." Always give the conclusion first, then the steps you took, the evidence you used, and any caveats.

Handling Errors: Practice saying: *"I would identify the claim, determine what evidence is needed, and check an authoritative source. I would document the error and explain how it affects usefulness."*

Handling Ambiguity: Practice saying: *"I check the full instructions first. If ambiguity remains, I identify competing interpretations.*

If it materially affects quality, I ask for clarification rather than inventing a rule."

9

Chapter 9

THE SIMULATION LAB: PRACTICE EXERCISES

Do not take a high-stakes assessment cold. Use these five simulations to train your judgment before you take a real platform test. Write your own rating and rationale before reading the expert judgment.

Simulation 1: Instruction Following

- **The Prompt:** 'Give two reasons to keep a project tracker.'
- **Response A:** 'It records application status and reminds you of follow-up actions.'
- **Response B:** 'It improves organization, boosts confidence, helps networking, makes resumes better, and guarantees you never miss an opportunity.'
- **Expert Judgment:** A follows the request for exactly two reasons and avoids making an unsupported guarantee. B gives more information than requested and makes an absolute

claim that cannot be justified.

Simulation 2: Unsupported Specificity

- **The Prompt:** 'What is Company X's application deadline?'
- **The Response:** 'November 17 at 5 p.m.' (Note: No date or source was supplied by the user).
- **Expert Judgment:** The response invents a specific deadline. You must consult the official listing or state that the deadline cannot be determined from the supplied information.

Simulation 3: Rubric Adherence

- **The Scenario:** The rubric explicitly states that factual correctness matters more than tone. Response A is correct but plain. Response B is friendly and confident but gives a wrong date.
- **Expert Judgment:** Response A must score higher based on the stated priority. Your rationale should explain why tone does not outweigh a factual error.

Simulation 4: Ambiguous Language

- **The Scenario:** A Spanish response uses a term common in one country but unusual in another. The prompt does not specify a locale.
- **Expert Judgment:** Do not automatically mark it wrong. Assess whether the meaning is clear, whether a neutral

alternative is needed, and whether the rubric specifies a regional standard. State your uncertainty if the evidence does not resolve it.

Simulation 5: Contradiction

- **The Scenario:** An AI's answer says a service is free in the first paragraph, but later says a monthly fee is required for the same plan.
- **Expert Judgment:** Check whether the statements refer to different tiers. If no distinction is given, the answer is internally contradictory and must be flagged and corrected.

10

Chapter 10

FINAL CHECKLIST & GLOSSARY

The Global Remote Worker Checklist

Before accepting your first contract, verify the following:

- **Location:** Is the role open to residents of your country and region? Does it require citizenship or a local phone number?
- **Payments:** Can you receive payments through an approved method from your country? What are the currency conversion and transfer rules?
- **Taxes:** Do local tax, registration, reporting, or independent contractor obligations apply to you? *(Note: Requirements vary by jurisdiction. Consult a qualified local professional.)*

Essential AI Terminology

- **AI Evaluator:** A person who assesses AI outputs against criteria such as correctness, usefulness, safety, or instruction-following.
- **Annotation:** Adding labels, tags, corrections, or structured information to data.
- **Hallucination:** A fabricated or unsupported claim presented as factual.
- **Human Feedback:** Judgments or examples supplied by people to help develop or evaluate AI systems.
- **LLM (Large Language Model):** A system trained to process and generate language.
- **Red Teaming:** Testing a system to identify weaknesses, unsafe behavior, or ways it can fail.
- **Rubric:** A set of criteria and standards used to evaluate work.

11

Chapter 11

BONUS CHAPTER: THE EXPERIENCED PROFESSIONAL'S ADVANTAGE

How to leverage decades of traditional career experience to dominate the AI workforce.

A massive misconception about the AI industry is that it is exclusively for 20-something computer science graduates. The reality is the opposite. As AI models become more advanced, the bottleneck is no longer basic coding; it is domain expertise, nuanced judgment, and executive-level reasoning.

If you have spent decades in academic education, executive leadership, or management, you possess a structural advantage over younger applicants. You have survived multiple societal and technological transitions. You already know how to evaluate complex information, mentor others, and apply strict operational standards.

How to Translate Your Legacy Experience:

- **Decades of Management:** You are not just "managing people." You are "evaluating complex, ambiguous workflows and applying consistent operational rubrics."
- **Academic Rigor:** If you have an academic background, you possess the exact skill set required for top-tier model evaluation: tracing claims to authoritative sources, identifying logical fallacies, and writing highly structured, defensible rationales.
- **The Transition Playbook:** Do not hide your age or experience. Lean into it. Position yourself as a "Domain Expert" or "Subject Matter Expert" (SME). Platforms like Mercor and Ethos actively seek out seasoned professionals—from retired lawyers to veteran financial analysts—because an AI cannot learn high-level professional judgment without a human who has actually lived it.

12

Chapter 12

BONUS CHAPTER: THE TECHNICAL EVALUATOR'S TECH STACK

The modern toolset for high-paying coding and quantitative evaluations.

The highest hourly rates on AI platforms are often reserved for technical evaluators. You do not need to be a full-time software engineer to secure these roles, but you do need to understand the modern AI development stack to effectively test generated code, database scripts, and automated pipelines.

To become a top-tier technical evaluator, familiarize yourself with these four foundational tools:

- **Cursor:** An AI-first code editor. Evaluators use this to quickly test generated code snippets, spot syntax errors, and verify if an AI's proposed solution actually executes.
- **Claude Code IDE:** Essential for running localized tests and evaluating complex logic. If you are assessing an AI's ability

to build quantitative trading bots or data pipelines, testing the output in a robust IDE is mandatory.

- **Next.js & Supabase:** The dominant frameworks for modern web applications. Familiarizing yourself with how Next.js handles front-end routing and how Supabase manages backend databases (and Row Level Security) will allow you to confidently evaluate full-stack coding prompts.

13

Chapter 13

THE SIMULATION LAB (EXPANDED)

Simulation 6: Actionability vs. Vagueness

- **The Prompt:** 'Give me a checklist for checking a remote job offer.'
- **Response A:** Lists the employer's official domain, contract, compensation, payment method, and warning signs.
- **Response B:** Says, 'Trust your instincts and never give anyone personal information.'
- **Expert Judgment:** A is more actionable. B is overbroad: legitimate onboarding can require personal information through secure official channels. A should still be checked for accuracy and completeness.

Simulation 7: Find the Unsupported Claim

- **The Statement:** 'Everyone who passes the assessment will receive at least 20 hours of paid work every week.'
- **Expert Judgment:** The guarantee is unsupported unless the contract explicitly provides it. Passing a qualification is not the same as guaranteed work allocation.

Simulation 8: Improve the Rationale

- **Weak Rationale:** 'B is bad and A is much better.'
- **Expert Judgment:** Name the criterion and evidence. For example: 'A follows the requested three-step format and includes the required warning. B omits the warning, so it fails an explicit instruction even though its tone is friendly.'

Simulation 9: Handle Source Uncertainty

- **The Scenario:** A prompt asks for a platform's current fee, but the supplied source is two years old.
- **Expert Judgment:** Treat the source as potentially stale and seek a current official source if research is allowed. Do not present the old fee as current without verification.

Simulation 10: The Halo Effect

- **The Scenario:** Two responses contain the same factual error, but one is elegant and the other awkward. The rubric

prioritizes factual correctness.

- **Expert Judgment:** Score the factual error consistently. Evaluate style separately if the rubric includes style; elegant wording does not erase a material error.

14

Chapter 14

YOUR NEXT ACTION STARTS TODAY

The hardest part of a new opportunity is converting interest into concrete action. You do not need to understand the entire AI economy before beginning. You just need a realistic target and a truthful application.

If you have not done so yet, go to **airemoteworkdashboard.com** right now.

1. Set up your free Master Profile.
2. Use the Resume Adapter to tailor your evidence.
3. Submit your first application today.

The opportunity is not a promise; it is an invitation. Stop waiting and start pursuing the roles that fit you.